

Foreign Keys in Relational Schemas

txt2tex example

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[*RecipeId*, *IngredientId*, *EmployeeId*, *CuisineTag*, *IngredientName*, *RecipeName*, *EmployeeName*, *PositionName*]

Pattern 1: Single-Attribute Primary Key

Each relation has exactly one pk line. txt2tex underlines the attribute in the schema box and emits a PK statement immediately after.

<u><i>Recipe</i></u> <u><i>recipeId</i></u> : <i>RecipeId</i> <i>name</i> : <i>RecipeName</i> <i>cuisine</i> : <i>CuisineTag</i>

<u><i>Ingredient</i></u> <u><i>ingredientId</i></u> : <i>IngredientId</i> <i>name</i> : <i>IngredientName</i>

Pattern 2: Composite Primary Key

Two pk lines in one schema body. Both attributes are underlined; txt2tex collapses them into one PK set: $PK(RecipeIngredient) = \{recipeId, ingredientId\}$.

<u><i>RecipeIngredient</i></u> <u><i>recipeId</i></u> : <i>RecipeId</i> <u><i>ingredientId</i></u> : <i>IngredientId</i>
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Pattern 3: Single-Attribute Foreign Key

A foreign key constraint says every value of the referencing attribute must appear in the referenced relation. No special keyword is needed: write the constraint as a Z predicate using forall/exists or projection with subset.

RecipeIngredient.recipeId must reference an existing Recipe:

$$\forall ri : RecipeIngredient \bullet \exists r : Recipe \bullet ri.recipeId = r.recipeId$$

Equivalently, using projection and subset:

$$Project_{recipeId}(RecipeIngredient) \subseteq Project_{recipeId}(Recipe)$$

RecipeIngredient.ingredientId must reference an existing Ingredient:

$$\forall ri : RecipeIngredient \bullet \exists i : Ingredient \bullet ri.ingredientId = i.ingredientId$$

Pattern 4: Composite FK and Self-Referential FK

Both FK constraints for *RecipeIngredient* can be stated together in a single zed block. Each predicate is separated by an *also* command in the output.

$$\forall ri : \textit{RecipeIngredient} \bullet \exists r : \textit{Recipe} \bullet ri.\textit{recipeId} = r.\textit{recipeId}$$

$$\forall ri : \textit{RecipeIngredient} \bullet \exists i : \textit{Ingredient} \bullet ri.\textit{ingredientId} = i.\textit{ingredientId}$$

Employee carries a *managerId* that references another row in the same relation. The self-referential FK constraint:

Employee

employeeId : *EmployeeId*

name : *EmployeeName*

position : *PositionName*

managerId : *EmployeeId*

Every *managerId* in *Employee* must match a valid *employeeId* in the same relation:

$$\forall e : \textit{Employee} \bullet \exists m : \textit{Employee} \bullet e.\textit{managerId} = m.\textit{employeeId}$$